



STATUS REPORT

Algeria — digital transformation and data governance status report

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ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Algeria's 5G networks reached every province within months of launch: Ooredoo extended service to all of the country's provinces by March 2026, ahead of a licence plan that opens with eight pilot wilayas and does not reach nationwide coverage until 2031, and Djezzy's network was live across 18 wilayas in the same month. The three licences went to Mobilis, Djezzy and Ooredoo in December 2025 against combined investment commitments of DZD 63.9 billion, about USD 492 million, following a competitive ARPCE tender opened in June 2025.

Fixed access has moved as fast. Three million households were connected to fibre to the home by February 2026 under a strategy that commits the state to retiring every legacy copper access line by 2027, carried on a nationwide 400G optical backbone built with Huawei. Mobile reach was close to complete before 5G arrived — 4G covered 99.1% of the population in 2024 — and Algérie Télécom plans 345 more base stations across 44 provinces, toward 4,500 localities by 2027 (February 2026).

72.9% of individuals used the internet in 2025, with about 116 mobile connections per 100 people, and 84% owned a smartphone in 2024. Algeria climbed fifteen places to 74th in the ITU's ICT Development Index published in June 2025, Ookla placed Algiers 48th in the world for mobile speed at 163.31 Mbps in May 2026, a rise of 68 places, and mobile communications recorded the largest ten-year gain of any of the 96 indicators the 2024 IIAG scores for Algeria, reaching 81.7 of 100 in 2023.

Domestic interconnection has not moved at that pace. An exchange point, AlgIX, is registered in Algiers, but Algérie Télécom's own network record lists no active public peering (2026). New international capacity is at the intention stage — Algérie Télécom and Sparkle have signed a memorandum of understanding on a submarine cable linking Italy to Algeria (July 2025) — while ARPCE has put satellite-ISP licences on non-geostationary constellations out to tender (April 2026). The incumbents' own terms are unsettled: the Council of Government examined draft decrees renewing the Mobilis and Djezzy cellular licences on 23 July 2026.

Data Storage

The state moved its own services onto infrastructure it owns in July 2026: [President Tebboune inaugurated the National Digital Services Center on 5 July](#), two high-availability data centres in active-active architecture, connected to 46 government ministries and hosting the national public services portal and the national database, certified to Uptime Institute Tier III Design in February 2026. The two sites, at Mohammadia in Algiers and at Blida, were built by the Chinese vendor Huawei, and they carry the national cloud and the Dzair digital services platform.

That is the culmination of a longer build rather than a standing start — [the first state data centre opened at Constantine in February 2023](#) — and the estate is still being extended into new tenants and new workloads. [Parliament signed an agreement in June 2026 to run its own systems on the state's sovereign cloud](#). Construction of a state-owned artificial-intelligence supercomputing and data centre at Oran was launched in March 2025, intended to give researchers, universities, startups and public institutions GPU and high-performance computing. Outside the state estate, [CERIST launched a cloud-computing platform on OpenStack and Kubernetes in March 2025](#) and [Djezzy announced an artificial-intelligence cloud platform with Algeria Venture and Taubyte in April 2026](#).

Who is kept out matters as much as what has been put in. [Algeria's localisation requirement shapes its cloud market](#), and no global hyperscale provider operates infrastructure in the country, which follows from the duty to hold personal data on Algerian data subjects on servers inside the country — a duty a draft platform-regulation bill would extend to the large foreign platforms themselves, requiring covered platforms to store user data on national territory or in approved data centres. Security of the estate is assigned rather than left open: [the High Commission for Digitalisation is responsible for ensuring the National Data Centre and National Cloud meet national cybersecurity standards](#).

Energy

Algeria's grid reaches everyone and runs on gas. [World Bank data put both urban and rural electricity access at 100% in 2023](#), with no meaningful divide between them, and the [2024 IIAG scores access to energy at 99.7 of 100 for 2023](#), 4th of 54 African states and effectively unchanged over the decade — one of the country's highest-scoring governance measures on any dimension. [Renewables supplied about 1% of generation in 2023](#), 926 GWh of 95,830 GWh, the rest overwhelmingly natural gas, and power is among the cheapest on the continent (2021). The gap is off-grid provision: [the World Bank's RISE assessment records no policy framework for off-grid electrification \(2025\)](#).

Technical Capacity

Operational work has begun to move onshore: [Djezzy deepened its partnership with Qvantel through a new managed-services hub in Algeria in March 2026](#), shifting parts of its business-support operations into the country. The state's own compute base for researchers and startups is [still under construction at Oran](#), and production of the biometric identity card and its security technology [rests on an external technical provider](#). Public training effort runs through the security side, with [a second cohort of information-systems security officers trained at Sidi Abdellah in June 2026](#) under the defence ministry's security agency, and policy advice through [a scientific and technical committee attached to the High Commission for Digitalisation](#). Algeria had published no assessment of the size or composition of its digital workforce as at August 2026.

Cybersecurity

Algeria gained its first sectoral incident-response capability in June 2026: MPT-CERT, a computer emergency response centre for the post and telecommunications sector, was inaugurated on 15 June to handle monitoring, alerting and incident response, stood up with South Korean technical support through KOICA.

Defence holds the centre of the system. The Information Systems Security Agency sits under the Ministry of National Defence and is charged with implementing national cyber policy, monitoring cyberspace and defending critical state infrastructure, and it works on live civilian systems: the national digital identity layer behind the Dzair Digital Services portal was tested and validated by the agency before the portal's launch was approved (2026). A national information-systems security strategy for 2025 to 2029 was established by presidential decree gazetted on 30 December 2025, and supervision of the national data-governance arrangement is divided between the National Council for Information-Systems Security, the data-protection authority and the security agency. The framing throughout is sovereignty, and it is anchored in defence rather than in a civilian ministry (April 2026).

Below the national bodies, the obligation now reaches every institution. A presidential decree gazetted in January 2026 requires every public institution, administration and body to create a structure responsible for information-systems security and personal-data protection, organisationally independent of the body's own IT function and attached directly to the head of the institution, with duties spanning a risk map, continuous audit and monitoring, immediate incident notification, security clauses in subcontracting, user training and coordination with the security agency and the data-protection authority. Its own commencement runs through further texts, the classification of the new posts left to a joint finance and public-service order and implementation to a public-service instruction.

The public face of all this is recent and thin: Algiers hosted the first Cyber Security Days on 14 June 2026, a national event on cybersecurity, digital sovereignty and innovation.

DPI

Data Exchange

Algeria's pension fund stopped asking retirees for a paper certificate of life in mid-2026: proof of life is now established by matching a live selfie against the biometric photograph held in the national identity card database, rolled out nationally with an awareness campaign in May and June 2026.

The legal basis arrived only at the end of 2025. Presidential Decree 25-320 of 30 December 2025 constitutes a système national d'interopérabilité as the exclusive channel for digital data exchange between public institutions, carried on a secure national interconnection network kept physically separate from the internet and built and administered by the High Commission for Digitalisation. The decree's duties on public bodies begin only from the date the Commission publishes the two data référentiels it requires, so exclusivity is not yet a running duty; administrations were given one month from 12 July 2026 to interconnect their systems with the national government data centres.

What actually crosses is narrower than the framework, and older than it. Citizens no longer submit civil status documents the national automated civil status register already holds, because authorised institutions including the Ministry of Justice retrieve them electronically (2023), and a single electronic company-creation portal run by the

trade register enrolls a new business simultaneously with the tax authority, the CASNOS and CNAS social security funds and the statistics office under one common identifier issued within three days (2023). The tax, customs, human resource, social insurance and procurement systems each exchange data with other government systems, while the whole-of-government interoperability framework was still in draft in 2025 and the exchange platform it would govern only partly in use.

Dzair Services, presented as the single national platform through which administrations exchange verified data automatically, was still being extended in early 2026, with services and administrations being added, and Algeria joined the 50-in-5 digital public infrastructure campaign in March 2026 as its fifteenth African member. Published analysis in *Le Matin d'Algérie* holds that forms are dematerialised without changing the logics that produce them, leaving the citizen to bridge administrations that still cannot talk to each other.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Algeria is extending the credential it already has rather than issuing a new one: national digital identity is tied to the biometric national identity card rather than to a separate credential, the approach carried into the law on electronic trust services and electronic identification adopted in February 2026.

The Numéro d'Identification National, instituted by executive decree in 2010, is generated automatically from civil status data at the point of birth registration and is the key linking the population register, the biometric identity card, the passport, the driving licence and vehicle registration; foreign nationals born in Algeria and legally resident there qualify for the number too, though the card itself goes only to citizens, foreign residents, refugees and asylum-seekers holding separate residence documents (2024). It carries two fingerprints in a match-on-card application and a facial photograph, held both on the card and in the Ministry of the Interior's central database, with no iris capture (2026); more than 16 million cards had been collected by October 2019, within three years of launch.

Underneath sits the country's strongest institutional showing of any kind: civil registration is the highest score Algeria records on any of the Ibrahim Index's 96 indicators, 100 out of 100 in 2023 and first of 54 African states.

The card opens a widening set of doors. It is the primary know-your-customer document under the 2005 anti-money-laundering law, with financial institutions required to verify identity against it; transfers of vehicle ownership require it (April 2026); the telecoms regulator's electronic authentication and signature service went live in September 2025; the social insurance fund began issuing an electronic health card to people without social cover in January 2026; and the diaspora could renew biometric passports remotely from June 2026.

Its reach stops short of systems people use most. Healthcare runs on a separate card issued by the social insurance fund rather than on the identity card, the civil service human resource system uses its own identifiers rather than the national identity number (2025), and production of the card and of the biometric passport rests on an outside supplier.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Electronic payments in Algeria rose 46% during 2025 to 939 billion dinars, around USD 7 billion – a rise the state news agency attributes largely to public administrations moving their own collections online rather than to people paying each other or their shopkeepers.

The instruments are spread far more widely than the habit. The card base passed 22 million by the end of March 2026, nearly 18 million of them Edahabia cards issued by the postal operator, while the instant mobile payment system DZ Mob Pay held 95,014 personal accounts at the end of 2025 and most person-to-business and business-to-business transactions stayed in cash (2024). Access to banking services is among Algeria's ten worst-scoring governance indicators, 19.6 out of 100 in 2023 and lower than a decade earlier, and the head of the national consumer-protection body for electronic commerce describes online selling as running largely through social media pages outside the 2018 e-commerce law and settling cash on delivery (2026).

Where money does move digitally, a rule has often removed the alternative. Electronic filing and payment through the tax portal Jibayatic is mandatory for taxpayers under the Directorate of Large Enterprises and optional for the real, simplified-real and flat-rate regimes (August 2026), and the tax administration's first published guide lists 17 causes of payment rejection and states that a rejected taxpayer cannot retry electronically but must attend a local tax office. The AADL3 social-housing programme takes payment by Edahabia or CIB card with no cash route (2025), and traffic fines have been payable across more than 2,000 terminals since May 2025.

The rule-making machinery was assembled late. Règlement 26-01 of 31 May 2026 fixes the composition and working arrangements of the National Payments Committee, whose mandate is to draft the national payments strategy Algeria does not yet have; three security services sit on it, and it owes an annual report on the state of payment instruments. Consumer protection rules specific to payment services followed in August 2025, and the central bank joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System in August 2025 as its eighteenth country.

Registries

Algeria began a nationwide rollout of the AMLAK electronic land system in January 2026, taking land titles fully electronic, and a decree of 27 January 2026 formalised an electronic land booklet to replace paper titles progressively — over a base in which around 60% of private land is not legally registered and holds no title at all (2024).

AMLAk has held general survey, land conservation and state-property functions on a single national database since January 2026, and notaries have had direct online access to the cadastral and land databases since an interoperability agreement of August 2025 between the finance ministry, the national assets directorate and the justice ministry, though cadastral delimitation is not complete nationwide (2025).

Company registration is the furthest along: the CNRC runs Sidjilcom as a fully digital trade register providing online registration, extracts and legal information (2026), and 173,651 new registrations were recorded against 125,195 strike-offs during 2025.

The register therefore grew by a net 48,456 businesses across 2025.

The Registre National de la Population is keyed by the national identification number and links the identity card, passport, driving licence, vehicle registration and civil status records across all 1,541 communes (2019), and the national automated civil status register holds around 102 million digitised historic acts — 68.65 million births, 17.70 million deaths and 15.64 million marriages (2019). Birth registration is 99.6% complete (2019), while registration of refugee and asylum-seeker children falls well short of that (2025).

Elsewhere the registers are complete but unconnected. 24,351,551 voters were registered for the September 2024 presidential election against a voting-age population of 30,243,035, and the roll is continuous and electronically updated but uses no biometric capture, leaving it unjoined to the biometric identity system (2026), even as the electoral authority ran an online portal for registration, removal and updates and a central hub monitoring roll revision across all 1,541 municipalities ahead of the July 2026 legislative election. The national agricultural registry was fully digitised by November 2024, with electronic farmer cards issued across all 58 wilayas, while the national addressing reference covers five of the 58 wilayas (2025).

Sectoral management information systems

The justice ministry's electronic filing and signature system runs at national scale, with 8 million judgments digitally signed and 58,000 appeal cases registered electronically (2026).

Tax is the other system operating at that scale. Electronic filing and payment through Jibayatic has been mandatory for all companies since 2022, and an instruction of 6 May 2026 extended it to all remaining tax structures nationwide. What it collects for remains weak: tax and revenue mobilisation is Algeria's poorest public administration measure on the Ibrahim Index, 32.4 out of 100 in 2023, 44th of 54 African states and down over the decade.

The line ministries have built quickly and separately. The health ministry has completed a national platform for real-time data exchange between hospitals alongside an electronic medical record rollout and a new National Digital Health Agency, but the unification of CNAS and CASNOS insurance data that full integration requires remains a costly and unmet reform (2026). The national agricultural information system, launched in June 2026, integrates land registers, livestock, fertiliser distribution, market monitoring, financing and climate indicators, with interoperability across other sectors still a work in progress, and the solidarity sector's integrated platform was piloted in two municipalities in March 2026. The higher education ministry reports 73 integrated digital platforms and the national education ministry runs online enrolment, transfer, exam registration and payment, neither confirmed as joined to the cross-government exchange, and the employment agency's WassitOnline, live since 2018, remains a standalone sectoral service (2024).

The core financial back office is further behind the sectoral systems. The civil service human resource system runs on custom software with manual paperwork still in the process, and the government payroll system is still being implemented, as is the treasury single account, used by only some ministries, departments and agencies (2025). Below the national platforms, rural clinics were still keeping handwritten patient folders and paper appointment books into 2026.

Of the ten core government back-office systems the World Bank's GovTech Maturity Index assesses, Algeria had seven in use, two still being implemented and one absent as at 2025.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Algeria has begun closing paper channels rather than only adding digital ones: vehicle registration went entirely digital on 5 April 2026, ending acceptance of manual applications at local offices, and from 1 August 2026 every services-import application must be lodged, processed and tracked through the foreign trade ministry's platform.

Dzair Services launched in October 2025 as a single window aggregating public services on a national interoperability layer connecting 46 ministries and agencies by fibre, and the Council of Ministers approved the operational launch of the Dzair Digital Services portal on 25 May 2026, with a digital identity layer tied to the biometric identity card as the gating credential, hosted in the national digital services centre inaugurated at Mohammadia in July 2026 and supported by a free helpline running seven days a week.

The apostille platform went live on 9 July 2026, replacing the multi-step manual legalisation chain for documents destined for use abroad, after accession to the Hague convention in August 2025; higher-education documents can be certified through it for recognition in more than 120 countries (July 2026). Lawyers have obtained certified copies of court decisions online since February 2026. Digitisation is not always complete: the platform for declaring lost documents, launched in November 2025, still requires a signed paper record at a police station within a set period.

The UN's 2024 e-government survey placed Algeria 116th of 193 states at 0.5956, its human capital component at 0.8129 against an online services component of 0.3320 — a population better equipped than the services offered to it. The national service portal is transactional and reaches ordinary users, yet no national digital transformation strategy has been adopted, with both the strategy and the machinery to deliver it still in draft (2025), and the economist Omar Berkouk warns that transformation is being counted in initiatives launched rather than in processing times cut or applications completed online (August 2026).

At least 19 distinct national digital public-service systems entered service or were announced between March 2025 and August 2026, spanning tax, notarial, judicial, land, commercial-registry, trade, health, agriculture, higher-education, SME, social-security and policing functions.

Governance

Legislation and regulation

Algeria replaced its decade-old electronic-signature regime in February 2026: [Law 26-02 of 17 February 2026 sets general rules for electronic trust services and electronic identification](#), defining electronic identification means and systems at three levels of assurance — low, substantial and high — and creating a National Electronic Certification Authority to supervise them. The same law [requires trust-service and electronic-identification providers to undergo periodic compliance audits](#), carried out by that authority, by the Information Systems Security Agency or by accredited auditors. It moved fast: the Council of Ministers approved the draft on 2 November 2025 and it was before the National People's Assembly in December.

The other instrument of the period is [Presidential Decree n° 25-320 of 30 December 2025](#), a twenty-article text in four chapters signed by President Tebboune and gazetted in *Journal Officiel* n° 87, which puts in place a national data-governance framework for the public sector. It splits supervision three ways — the National Council for Information-Systems Security over the operation of the dispositif, the ANPDPC over personal-data conformity, and the ASSI over security-level classification — and its Article 19 starts the data-classification and data-source-cataloguing duties on public bodies from the date the High Commission for Digitalisation publishes the two référentiels required by Article 8.

[Presidential Decree n° 26-07 of 7 January 2026](#) requires every Algerian public institution, administration and body to create a structure responsible for information-systems security and personal-data protection. Its own machinery is left to texts below it: [Article 8](#) hands classification of the new security posts to a joint Finance and Public-Service order, and [Article 13](#) leaves implementation to a Public-Service instruction.

Beneath the recent decrees sits a thinner statutory stack: [Law 09-04 of 2009 on offences linked to information and communication technologies](#), [Law 18-05 of 10 May 2018 on electronic commerce](#), [Law 20-04 of 2020 on radiocommunications](#) and [Law 18-07 of 10 June 2018 on personal data](#). Artificial intelligence has no statute: legislation to regulate its ethical use was reported in preparation in November 2025.

Strategies, plans and policies

Algeria's largest commitment of the period was gazetted rather than published: [Presidential Decree n° 25-321 established the National Information-Systems Security Strategy 2025–2029](#) in the same Journal Officiel issue of 30 December 2025 as the data-governance decree. It was unveiled on 3 March 2026 by the Ministry of National Defence, through the Information Systems Security Agency, and rests on three objectives approved by President Tebboune: protecting critical infrastructure, securing sensitive state data and ensuring continuity of services. Its home is not incidental — cyber policy is framed explicitly as digital sovereignty and anchored in Defence rather than in a civilian ministry.

The civil programme has a named owner. [Digital Algeria 2030](#), launched in 2023 and succeeded by the [National Digital Transformation Strategy 2025–2030](#), is structured around seven pillars including interoperability and data exchange, with implementation overseen by the High Commission for Digitalisation created by presidential decree on 6 September 2023. The Commission added a fifteen-member Scientific and Technical Committee in Algiers on 23 October 2025, three of its members drawn from the diaspora, under High Commissioner Meriem Benmouloud, the same account carrying its targets of ICT jobs in the hundreds of thousands and a fifth of GDP. The [data-governance framework](#) was formally launched on 9 February 2026 at a ceremony presided over by minister Ghrieb, which installed a national commission to follow up its implementation. Artificial intelligence is a step behind: the Prime Minister chaired a government meeting on 25 May 2026 that reviewed the draft national AI strategy, with its action plans to follow only once the Council of Ministers adopts it. External support has attached to the same frame: a UNDP agreement signed in November 2025 and a UNDP project funded jointly with Japan, running 2027 to 2030.

The administration expected to deliver it is losing ground on the one long-run measure available. Algeria scored 55.7 of 100 for overall governance in 2023, 18th of 54 African states, 1.4 points worse over five years against an African average that gained 0.1, and its Budgetary and Financial Management score fell 19.5 points over the decade to 47.2, 35th of 54.

Regional collaboration

Algeria has moved from signing continental agendas to convening them: African telecommunications and ICT ministers meeting under the African Telecommunications Union [adopted the Algiers Declaration on African Telecommunications Sovereignty and Integrated Connectivity](#), a continental agenda covering 2026 to 2030, and Algeria hosted the ministerial meeting that produced it in March 2026.

The bilateral track runs in two directions. [Algeria and Tunisia agreed to expand telecommunications and ICT cooperation at the fourth session of their Joint Technical Commission](#) in June 2026, an established recurring mechanism; [Algeria and Niger agreed to strengthen cooperation on telecommunications and digital development](#) in March 2026, a southward track alongside the continental role. Northwards, a [memorandum of understanding on telecommunications and postal cooperation was signed with Italy](#) at the fifth Algeria–Italy High-Level Summit in July 2025.

The multilateral commitments are pledges rather than plumbing. Algeria [joined the 50-in-5 digital public infrastructure campaign](#) in March 2026, and the central bank [joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System](#) in August 2025, though [commercial banks were still completing their own connectivity through 2026](#). The estate does reach across the border in one place: the [Apostille e-legalisation platform](#) went live on 9 July 2026, replacing the manual chain for documents destined for use abroad.

Contact with Smart Africa remains at the level of talks: its chief executive [met Minister Sid Ali Zerrouki in Geneva on 13 July 2026](#) on AI adoption and digital integration, covering the Africa AI Council and Algeria's participation in the Smart Market Initiative. A week earlier Algeria had [argued at the UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance in Geneva for practical, implementable measures](#) — technology transfer, capacity building and narrowing the digital divide.

Standards

Algeria writes its data standards as a precondition rather than a guideline: under [Presidential Decree 25-320](#) a public body may use the national interoperability system only after classifying its data and cataloguing it against two référentiels to be published by the High Commission for Digitalisation, and a data user needs the issuing body's consent through the system before exploiting data. The framework those rules would sit inside is not itself settled — the whole-of-government interoperability framework is recorded as planned or in draft, with the exchange platform it would govern already partly in use (2025). A data-governance body is established as an autonomous institution (2025).

Certification is split in two. Algeria [operates a Governmental Electronic Certification Authority](#) for state bodies alongside ARPCE's national certification authority, the regulator having been designated the national electronic-certification authority in January 2025; Law 26-02 has since put a statutory audit duty on trust-service providers. The High Commission is responsible for ensuring that the National Data Centre and National Cloud meet national cybersecurity standards.

Elsewhere standards are enforced through purchasing and accreditation rather than published specifications. The [electronic government procurement system](#) in use for online tendering and contract management is used to enforce technical standards (2025), the Council of Government [reviewed progress on a national accreditation, conformity and certification network](#) and its GEOLAB digital platform on 23 July 2026, and the country has [launched the generalisation of IPv6 across its internet infrastructure](#) (July 2026). There is [no government open-source policy](#) (2025).

Data protection

Algeria's data-protection authority ruled in July 2026 that photographs are personal data: its [délibération of 15 July](#) holds that any photograph or video permitting the direct or indirect identification of a natural person falls under Law 18-07, so its collection, storage, retention and publication require a legal basis. Publishing a person's image on a social or digital platform now takes free, explicit, prior and verifiable consent absent a statutory exception, with prior notice of the controller, the purpose, the distribution and the retention period, and the Authority treats platforms whose infrastructure sits outside Algeria as engaging the international-transfer rules of the same law.

It follows earlier texts on workplace video surveillance and on the designation of data-protection officers. The regulator behind them was created by Law 18-07, had its board appointed in 2022, and has exercised investigatory, audit and enforcement powers over all personal-data processing since August 2023; it opened a compliance push on data retention in December 2025, pressing controllers to appoint a data-protection officer and keep a register of processing, and is chaired by Samir Bourehil (2026). Complaints over unlawful publication of images lie to it as well as to the courts.

The statute was strengthened by Law 25-11 of 24 July 2025, which requires data protection officers, records of processing activities and impact assessments for high-risk processing, expands the authority's enforcement powers, and defines biometric data explicitly. Controllers must notify a breach within five days and affected individuals without delay, with criminal penalties reaching ten years' imprisonment and fines of 10,000,000 dinars, and personal data on Algerian data subjects must be stored on servers inside the country.

Two limits sit around the regime. Article 18 of the December 2025 data-governance decree excludes defence, national-security and judicial data from the framework altogether, while Article 4 subjects the personal data inside it to the existing protection regime rather than setting a new standard. A National Authority for the Prevention and Combating of ICT-Related Crimes monitors electronic communications, and Algeria's Digital Freedom score fell 9.4 points over 2014–2023 to 21.2 of 100, 48th of 54 African states.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The room to argue about digital policy has narrowed faster than almost anything else Algeria is measured on. Civil Society Space scored 10.9 of 100 in 2023, 50th of 54 African states after a 13.4-point fall over the decade, and Deliberative & Participatory Governance 44.2, 39th, after a 9.0-point fall. Over the same period Media Freedom fell 18.3 points to 33.8, 47th of 54, and Freedom of Expression & Belief 13.6 points to 25.0, 48th — both among the ten most deteriorated of the index's 96 indicators.

The participation machinery is being built regardless. Algeria has a public e-participation platform (2025) and a citizen feedback mechanism for public services, with government responses recorded as reaching back to citizens (2025), and the national police opened an anonymous online public-security perception survey in August 2026, reachable by QR code, asking citizens to rate their sense of security so the force can steer operational priorities.

What is under consideration points the other way. The Council of Government [examined a draft national information-verification system on 23 July 2026](#), framed as counter-disinformation and intended to protect the integrity of information and strengthen public trust in the digital media ecosystem. A [bill to regulate digital platforms](#)

has been under examination at the [Assemblée populaire nationale](#) since October 2025, and would put content-removal duties on covered platforms and create a regulator attached to the Presidency with powers to fine and to block.

On access to records the position is improving from a low base. [Accountability & Transparency](#) is one of Algeria's three worst-scoring governance sub-categories at 30.4 of 100 in 2023, 36th of 54 and below its 2014 level, though disclosure and accessibility of public records both rose over the decade to 2023. Published analysis in [Le Matin d'Algérie](#) argues that the state digitises its administrative façades faster than it reforms the mechanisms behind them, so duplication persists, data circulates badly and the citizen still bridges administrations that cannot talk to each other.

Inclusion

Digital divides

Algeria's divide is geographic before it is anything else: [services and networks cluster in the populated north](#), and [connectivity across the Saharan and remote interior remains a gap](#) the Digital Algeria 2030 strategy itself concedes (2025). The state has instruments pointed straight at it — a [universal-service programme for low-density zones](#), a [satellite-ISP market opened on the stated rationale of reaching remote and isolated areas](#), and a [state-operator 4G build aimed at localities rather than cities](#) — but none of them alters the economics underneath, in which [extending coverage past the commercially profitable urban areas costs more than the urban build itself](#).

The older infrastructure divide has already closed. [Electricity reaches urban and rural households alike](#) (2023), and [most of the population uses the internet](#) (2025). What has not closed is the divide inside the state: [most municipalities still have no functioning website](#) (2025), which leaves a resident of an interior commune further from an online administration than the connection figures imply, whatever the network reaches.

Two lines of exclusion cut across the geography. [Women's share of social media use runs well below men's](#) (2025), and [digital skills programmes reach citizens on a fee-paying basis](#) (2025), which sorts entry to the training by income — even as [the national digital empowerment programme has drawn enrolments from every wilaya](#) (May 2026). The sharpest statement of where this ends up was put in the Algerian press in July 2026: [unequal access to infrastructure, training and equipment turns a digital-only administration into a selective bureaucracy](#), and [dematerialisation without transparency or firm data guarantees reads to users as one more constraint rather than a service](#).

Access to services

Algeria ranks fourth in Africa on [the Ibrahim Index's assessment of how evenly public services are provided across groups](#), at 72.7 of 100 in 2023, with the companion measure of [women's access to public services](#) at 89.0 after an 18.0-point rise over the decade. Set against that, [the same profile puts legal protection against discrimination at the bottom of its range, unchanged across the same ten years](#) (2023): even provision rests on how services are run rather than on a protection a person could invoke when they are not.

What a person must hold is the real gate. The national identification number is open to foreign nationals born in Algeria and legally resident there under Executive Decree 10-210, but the biometric identity card is issued to citizens only, and government social services are reached through that card — so the number that identifies a resident foreigner does not by itself open anything. For people outside the citizen register the position is measured: UNHCR's 2025-2027 strategy records 75-80% of refugees and asylum-seekers holding legally recognised identity documents, and birth registration for refugee and asylum-seeker children under five at 65% against a 97% target (2025).

Where the state has moved, it has moved by credential: an electronic card launched in January 2026 gives the most vulnerable beneficiaries access to medication. The friction sits further down. Digital literacy remains a barrier to using government platforms, particularly in remote areas (2025); standardised addressing covers only a small minority of the wilayas (2025); acceptance rather than card issuance is what binds electronic payment (March 2026), with most transactions still settling in cash (2024). And a digital channel can be the only channel: the foreign-trade ministry's services-import platform launched in July 2026 with no assisted or fallback route announced alongside it, where the free helpline stood up for the national services portal at the end of July 2026 at least gives a user who cannot work the screen someone to call.

Technology

AI

Algeria has an implementation roadmap for artificial intelligence in public services before it has a published strategy. A joint inter-ministerial roadmap was agreed to deploy the technology across public services, prioritising sovereign open-source models, high-performance computing centres, national data storage and stronger safeguards for public-sector applications, with intensive university training programmes, a dedicated research centre and specialised research units, and a joint monitoring committee to oversee delivery against a stated timeline (reported 12 August 2026). The strategy underneath it was still a draft as at May 2026, reviewed at a government meeting with its action plans to follow only once it is adopted, no adoption instrument is on file, and legislation on the ethical use of the technology was reported in preparation in November 2025. What is settled is the machinery around the policy rather than the policy itself. Algeria's 2025 submission to the UN Commission on Science and Technology for Development names a National School of Artificial Intelligence and the Sidi Abdellah technology park among its specialised digital institutions, and the country has taken a position abroad, arguing at the UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance in Geneva for practical, implementable governance measures in July 2026, with accession to an international artificial-intelligence body among the initiatives recorded over the following month.

What is running sits with operators, universities and a new cluster rather than inside the administration. Algérie Télécom's "AI for digital inclusion" project took a WSIS Forum certificate of appreciation in the ICT-infrastructure category in Geneva in July 2026, from a field of 1,595 projects across 122 countries. Algeria has opened a first technology and innovation centre for virtual-education systems, applying artificial intelligence to distance and online teaching (June 2026), and launched a first national artificial-intelligence and cybersecurity startup cluster at Sidi Abdellah in April 2026. The state's own compute is not yet behind any of it: construction of the artificial-intelligence supercomputing and data centre at Oran was launched in March 2025. Demand is ahead of both — artificial intelligence is the most-chosen track in the national digital empowerment programme (May 2026).

ICT Industry

The state electronics manufacturer ENIE now [installs and maintains every electronic payment terminal in the country, whatever its brand or origin](#) (July 2026), having already brought manufacture of the card-acceptance estate in-country, while [production of the biometric identity card and passport stays with a foreign supplier](#). That split runs through the sector. On the domestic side, SATICOM makes telecom and satellite equipment and was [held up as home-grown capacity during a ministerial inspection in September 2025](#); a plan to build a structured video-game and e-sports industry was [adopted in February 2026](#); and the state buys from small firms as well as its own, with [technology startups engaged in the delivery of public services, financing or support arrangements in place and public-private partnerships used for online delivery](#) (2025). The largest private technology company is consumer-facing rather than industrial: Yassir, in ride-hailing and delivery, [bought the Uno hypermarket chain](#) in March 2026. The core of the network remains foreign-built and foreign-run — the national 400G optical backbone was [built with Huawei](#), and one operator's business-support operations run through [a managed-services hub with Qvantel](#) (March 2026).

Innovation ecosystem

Algeria placed [115th of 133 economies in WIPO's Global Innovation Index 2024](#), and what the two years since have added is institutions rather than measured output. [At least four AfriLabs member innovation hubs are active](#) — Technopole Constantine Hill, the PAUWES Entrepreneurship Hub, IncubeMe Algeria and Sylabs (2025). Algeria [launched its first national artificial-intelligence and cybersecurity startup cluster at the Sidi Abdellah science and technology hub on 18 April 2026](#), pairing universities, research centres and firms. The public research centre CERIST [launched a cloud platform, a drone system and a startup incubator](#) in March 2025, and steering of the research base moved to the centre of government in June 2026 with two bodies, a High Council of Scientists and a national archaeology agency, [created under the direct authority of the Presidency](#).

Government's own machinery for absorbing new things is the thinner half: Algeria has [a public-sector innovation strategy or a programme but not both, and a dedicated unit covering public-service innovation that is planned or in progress rather than established](#) (2025). The incentives run ahead of it. [Initial public offering fees for startups have been waived until 2028](#) to bring young technology companies onto the Algiers exchange (February 2026), and the knowledge-economy policy carries [a startup target for 2029](#). The convening is continental as well as domestic: the AfCFTA Secretariat and Algeria are [partnering on the Africa Start-up Conference 2026](#), and Algiers hosted the [first Cyber Security Days on 14 June 2026](#) on cybersecurity, digital sovereignty and innovation. What the hubs, clusters and incentives have produced was not established as at August 2026.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

No American government programme or United States platform operator had a stated role in Algeria's digital estate as at August 2026.

China activities

Both layers of the state's digital estate were built by the same Chinese vendor: the [twin active-active data centres behind government digital services](#), and the [optical transport backbone carrying Algérie Télécom's fibre programme](#). Algeria and Huawei were in [discussion on artificial intelligence and the digital economy](#) in April 2026. The relationship is with a supplier of pipes and halls, not with a Chinese state programme or a source of capital.

EU activities

Europe's part in Algeria's digital plans is Italy's, and it is on paper. Algeria and Italy [signed a memorandum of understanding on telecommunications and postal cooperation](#) at the fifth Algeria–Italy High-Level Summit in July 2025, and in the same month Algérie Télécom and Sparkle [set out an intention to lay a new submarine cable between Italy and Algeria](#). Both are memoranda, which commit neither side to build anything.

India activities

India had no state or corporate presence in Algeria's technology build through to August 2026.

Gulf/UAE activities

Gulf capital and Emirati operators had no stated part in Algeria's networks, data centres or digital government as at August 2026.

Capacity

Literacy

Education is the fastest-deteriorating of Algeria's sixteen governance sub-categories, [down 14.3 points over 2014-2023 to 56.6 of 100 and 22nd of 54 African states](#), moving against the country's overall governance trajectory (2023). The fall is not in schooling itself, where all four measures rose over the same decade and rank high on the continent: [enrolment 78.9 of 100 and second of 54, completion 81.8 and eighth, equality in education 68.9 and seventh, and quality 53.6 and twelfth](#) (2023).

Above school level the intake is unusually technical. [Science and engineering accounted for 34.2% of tertiary graduates, around eighth in the world on that measure, with gross tertiary enrolment at 52.6% \(2021\)](#).

That record does not carry across into the systems people are asked to use. Algeria's [human capital component sits far above its online services component](#) in the UN E-Government Survey 2024, and [digital literacy remains a barrier to using government platforms, particularly in remote areas](#) (2025). Where schooling has itself been digitised, the 2024-25 programme [moved first-grade enrolment to an online portal for parents and put tablets and digital textbooks into a limited number of selected schools, chosen partly on whether their electricity supply was reliable, rather than digitising day-to-day record capture inside them](#).

The state's answer for adults is the ["7.77" national digital empowerment programme, open to citizens aged 7 to 77 and aimed at raising basic digital skills across the population](#) (May 2026). Digital skills provision for citizens is [recorded as fee-based on the World Bank's GovTech Maturity Index 2025 update](#).

Training and skills

Artificial intelligence is what Algerians are signing up to learn: of 64,508 registrations for the "7.77" programme, 19,691 chose the AI track, level with productivity tools at 19,576 and ahead of professional cybersecurity (9,678), digital entrepreneurship (9,083) and digital discovery (8,237) (May 2026).

Registration reached all 58 wilayas by May 2026, and registrants chose remote delivery over in-person by 80.4% to 19.6%, with 61.4% aged 23 to 45 and a further 20.4% aged 18 to 22, against 3,199 children aged 7 to 10 and 181 people aged 61 to 77 (May 2026). A programme branded seven to seventy-seven is in practice carried by working-age adults teaching themselves at home.

Training aimed at the state's own staff is narrower. Algeria has a public sector digital skills strategy or programme, but not both, its content recorded as advanced data science and data literacy (2025).

The specialised pipelines are small and tied to named roles. The national higher school of computer science, founded in 1969, graduates around 180 engineers a year (2021). A second cohort of information systems security officers was trained at Sidi Abdellah under the Ministry of National Defence's Information Systems Security Agency, framed as building the human capacity for digital sovereignty (June 2026). A twelve-week national artificial-intelligence vocational programme, with an incubation stage for participants' projects, launched in April 2026.

The universities are next. The higher education minister announced on 25 July 2026 that from the 2026-27 academic year every student's learning pathway will be steered by an intelligent assistant matching modules to their competences and career goals, alongside a large language model for lecturers that generates exercises and marks student answers, and the first technology and innovation centre for virtual-education systems opened in June 2026.

Research institutions

Steering of the research base moved to the centre of government in June 2026, when a High Council of Scientists and a national archaeology agency were created under the direct authority of the Presidency. The institutions doing the work are public and older: CERIST, the state research centre for scientific and technical information, put its own cloud platform and a startup incubator into service in March 2025, and the national higher school of computer science runs a doctoral programme and two research laboratories (2021). Government's own account to the UN names the National School of Artificial Intelligence and the Sidi Abdellah technology park among its specialised digital institutions (2025), where a first AI and cybersecurity startup cluster pairing universities, research centres and firms opened on 18 April 2026. The state-owned AI supercomputing centre at Oran, under construction since March 2025, is intended to give researchers and universities high-performance computing of their own.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

Not one of the four indicators in the Rural Economy sub-category of the 2024 Ibrahim Index of African Governance could be scored for Algeria, part of a wider blank of 18 of the index's 96 indicators on which the country carries no data. That is not for want of registers. The national agricultural registry has been digitised, and the agriculture ministry has put an integrated national information system over the farm register, the land register and livestock and

support-programme modules. What sits underneath is thinner: the World Bank's record shows [no agricultural census in Algeria in the past twenty years](#), so the sector's digital picture rests on what claimants register rather than on any recent enumeration of the ground.

Capture at the point where the person or the asset actually is remains mostly manual. Rural primary schools [record attendance, enrolment and grades on paper at the school](#), with electronic administration confined to a few specific functions. Data capture in rural primary healthcare clinics is [still largely paper](#), and the national electronic patient record was in planning and early rollout through 2026. Complaints and incidents at rural gendarmerie brigades are first recorded in [a handwritten procès-verbal that the citizen must attend in person to make](#).

The distinction that gets lost here is between reaching a rural area and recording anything in it. [4G reaches almost the entire population](#) (2024), and the platform for [declaring a lost document, opened in November 2025](#), can be reached from anywhere — but it still ends in a signed paper procès-verbal produced at a police station, and the service sits with the urban-facing national police. The opening of satellite-ISP licensing was justified by [reaching remote and isolated areas and supporting IoT in agriculture, mining and transport](#) (April 2026), which describes a prospect for capture in the interior rather than a system already running there.

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Most Algerian municipalities [still have no functioning website of their own](#), and subnational participation in the national data exchange remained planned rather than operational in 2025, even as dozens of ministries and central agencies were connected by fibre. The digital state below the national level is largely something built downward into the communes rather than by them: connection of communes to the [national civil-status platform](#) was still being rolled out wilaya by wilaya in 2023, one programme covering 85 mairies in Mascara, and the [national addressing database](#) run by the interior ministry with the space agency was still working outward from its pilot wilayas in 2025.

Where something distinctively municipal has appeared, an operator has supplied it: Ooredoo launched a [smart-city pilot in Sétif combining 5G and IoT services](#) in February 2026. "Electronic municipalities" are [a named strand of the e-government strategy](#), which is a different thing from communes running systems of their own.

Data

National statistics

Algeria has held [no agricultural census in the past twenty years](#), and its survey programme is thinner still: [no labour force survey and no business or establishment survey in the past ten years, and a single household survey in that decade against two agricultural surveys and three or more health surveys](#) (2023). A population census has been run within the last ten years and a business census within the last twenty, so the gap is specific rather than general — it falls on work, on enterprise and on farming, which are the three things a state cannot infer from anywhere else.

The World Bank's five-pillar reading of the system puts [data use and data products in the 70-89% band while data services, data sources and data infrastructure each fall in the 50-69% band](#) (2023). The weakness is upstream of the numbers, in the collecting rather than the publishing, which is the same account the census and survey record gives.

Algeria scores 47.2 of 100 for the capacity of its statistical system, 29th of 54 African states and 4.4 points better than a decade earlier (2023). That mid-table placing sits well below the country's 18th on the same index's overall governance ranking — the statistical system is a laggard relative to the state around it, not in step with it. The same profile cannot score Algeria's rural economy at all, for want of the underlying indicators.

The registration base beneath all this is sound: birth registration is close to complete, and the state has been standing up sectoral administrative systems quickly, from agriculture to small and medium enterprises to market supply and prices. Those systems count what passes through them, which is not the same population a survey samples.

Open data

Open Data Watch's 2024 inventory scores Algeria zero out of ten in seven categories — digital-economy statistics, built environment, pollution, crime, food security and nutrition, gender statistics and poverty. Its highest anywhere in the inventory are balance of payments at 5.5 and population and vital statistics at 5.0, barely past the midpoint of the scale; the bulk of the rest cluster between 3.0 and 4.0, with money and banking and natural resources at 4.0 and national accounts, labour, energy and education outcomes at 3.0. Health scores lower than any of them, facilities and outcomes at 2.5 each (2024).

Algeria does run an open government data portal publishing basic information and datasets (2025). A portal at that level is somewhere to put data rather than evidence that data has been put there, and the inventory scores are the measure of what arrived.

Every measure in the World Bank's 2025 index that asks whether Algeria publishes the documents, assessments or operating arrangements behind its digital government is answered no.

Access to the state's own records has improved from a low base: Disclosure of Public Records rose 8.5 points to 32.3 of 100, 30th of 54, and Accessibility of Public Records 4.6 points to 28.9, 29th over 2014-2023, leaving accountability and transparency among Algeria's worst-scoring areas of governance (2023).

The presidential decree of 30 December 2025 that set the national framework for public data governance has been criticised for omitting open data and reuse (January 2026), and a national data catalogue is targeted for launch in the second half of 2026. What is known about the workings of the data exchange itself comes through launch events, press statements and published strategy documents (2026). Where routine publication does exist it is narrow and sits outside central government: GIE Monetique puts out annual and monthly statistics across five payment channels, while the Justice Ministry's February 2026 system for certified copies of court decisions opened them to lawyers rather than to the public.

Use of satellite data

ARPCE put two satellite-ISP licences out to tender in April 2026, using non-geostationary constellations and opening Algeria's satellite communications market to competition. The regulator's stated purpose is reaching remote areas and carrying machine-to-machine traffic for farming, mining and transport — satellites as a delivery route for connectivity, not as a source of data about the country. No national Earth-observation or geospatial data programme had been made public as at August 2026.

Finance

New investments

Algeria approved [USD 1 billion to finance African startups](#) in October 2025, announced by the Minister of Foreign Trade and Export Promotion at an African ministerial meeting on the sidelines of UNCTAD16 in Geneva — money aimed at the rest of the continent rather than at Algeria's own digital estate, and money approved rather than moved. The vehicle for it is the [African Startup and Young Innovators Financing Fund](#), launched by President Tebboune in September 2025 and aimed at technology, education, healthcare and humanitarian projects.

Algeria's digital-sector financing in 2025 was its own money. The two commitments on the year are a pledge by the Algerian state to a fund the state created, and spectrum licence money paid to the state by three telecoms operators, two of them domestic or state-linked.

Domestic capital is where the movement is, and it is early. [Algérie Télécom announced an investment fund for startups working in artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and robotics](#) at the third CTO Forum Algeria in February 2025 — an announcement rather than capital deployed. At the other end of the year [VOLZ raised DZD 600 million, about USD 5 million at the time](#), in December 2025, the first exit for the Algerian Startup Fund. The state has also [waived initial public offering fees for startups until 2028](#) to draw young technology companies onto the Algiers exchange.

The other large sum in play is private and conditional: the investment Mobilis, Djezzy and Ooredoo committed against [Algeria's first 5G licence awards](#) in December 2025, an envelope to be spent on building the networks rather than a sum already in the ground.

MoUs and other agreements

Algeria signed cooperation memoranda with Moscow and London within weeks of each other in November 2025: a [cybersecurity memorandum between Russia's Positive Technologies and Proxylan](#), a subsidiary of the state research centre CERIST, and one between [the national police force DGSN and the UK Home Office](#) on digital forensics and biometrics for policing. Neither attaches a value or a delivery obligation to the intent.

That pattern runs through the rest of what has been signed. [Algérie Télécom and the notarial profession](#) agreed in July 2025 to digitise notarial services; [Algeria and Italy](#) signed on telecommunications and postal cooperation at the fifth Algeria–Italy High-Level Summit in the same month; [Algérie Télécom and Sparkle](#) put their names to a submarine cable linking Italy to Algeria, with no construction contract behind it; and [Djezzy and INATEL](#) announced a strategic partnership in April 2026 framed around industrial capability and technological sovereignty. None of them states a value, a workplan or a date by which anything must be delivered, which is the difference between a signature and a commitment.

What has produced something is the work with development partners. [MPT-CERT, the sectoral cyber incident response centre, was stood up with South Korean technical support through KOICA](#) and opened in June 2026 — an institution running rather than an intention recorded. The [agreement with the UN Development Programme of](#)

November 2025 and the [UNDP project funded jointly with Japan](#) signed in May 2026 both attach to the national digital transformation strategy, and the second runs on an executive plan that begins in 2027, after the period this report covers.

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